

Veterans Small Business Resource Guide



You served us. Now we serve you.

For more information contact Norm Phillips

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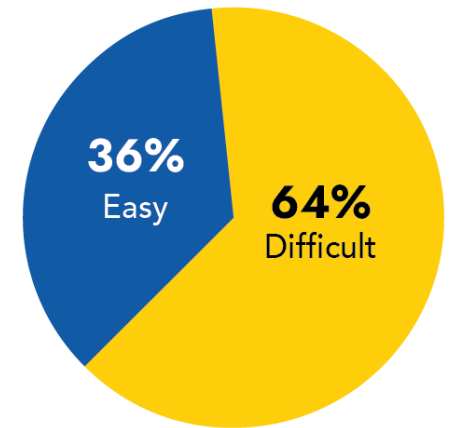
<https://www.score.org/find-mentor>

| Transition Challenges for Veterans

Transition Challenges for Veterans

- Largest stressor during transitioning is finding suitable employment (2/3 of Veterans)
- Veterans are significantly more likely to be underemployed than nonveterans
- 35% of surveyed Veterans are likely to pursue entrepreneurship
- Veterans are approx. 5% of population but own 10% of small businesses and 14% of franchises
- 85% of veteran-owned businesses consider themselves successful (*Institute for Veterans and Military Families 2022 survey*)
- U.S. Bureau of Labor Data for All Small Businesses
 - 45% fail during first 5 years
 - 65% fail during first 10 years

Ease of transition to civilian life



Reasons Why Veterans Make Successful Entrepreneurs



1 Strong leadership skills

2 Adaptability and problem-solving abilities

3 Discipline and work ethic

4 Resilience and determination

Unique Small Business Opportunities for Veterans vs. Civilian Population

- Veterans have additional loans and grant funding available to them that are not available to civilians
- Service-Disabled Veterans can bid on set-aside (5%) Federal Government contracts not eligible to civilians
- Take advantage of Veterans Employment and Training Service through Department of Labor
- Use networking strategies with other veterans to uncover new business contacts and opportunities
- Differentiate small businesses as being Veteran-owned through marketing programs to both Veteran and civilian populations

SCORE Resources & Services

SCORE Primary Services



Free Mentoring

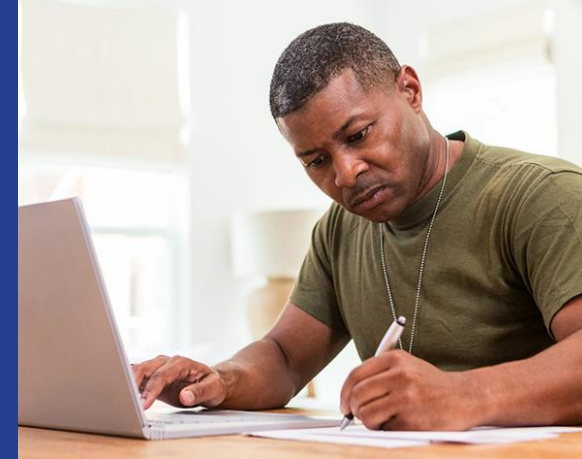
Entrepreneurs can access free, confidential business mentoring in person or remotely via email, phone and video. SCORE mentors, all experts in entrepreneurship and related fields, meet with their small business clients on an ongoing basis to provide continued advice and support.

*Note: SCORE assists in accessing potential sources of funding
SCORE does not provide grants or loans

SCORE Primary Resources

Library of Online Resources

Business owners can also benefit from SCORE's extensive collection of guides, templates, checklists, blogs, videos, infographics, and more. We strive to provide the most relevant and current educational content to help small business owners and entrepreneurs succeed.



Local Webinars & Workshops

Many local SCORE chapters hold free or low-cost in-person or online workshops and roundtable discussions covering various topics.

Veterans Resource Guide - Course Content

Guide contains SCORE and SBA curated resources

- Used in conjunction with SCORE mentoring sessions
- Includes webinars, courses, and articles
- Mentors have complete flexibility to use Resource Guide materials or substitute with other SCORE materials as preferred
- 7 SCORE resources specifically for Veterans
- Includes section on Veteran funding opportunities through SBA/VBOC

Veterans Resource Guide - Course Content

Resource Guide has been extensively market research tested with:

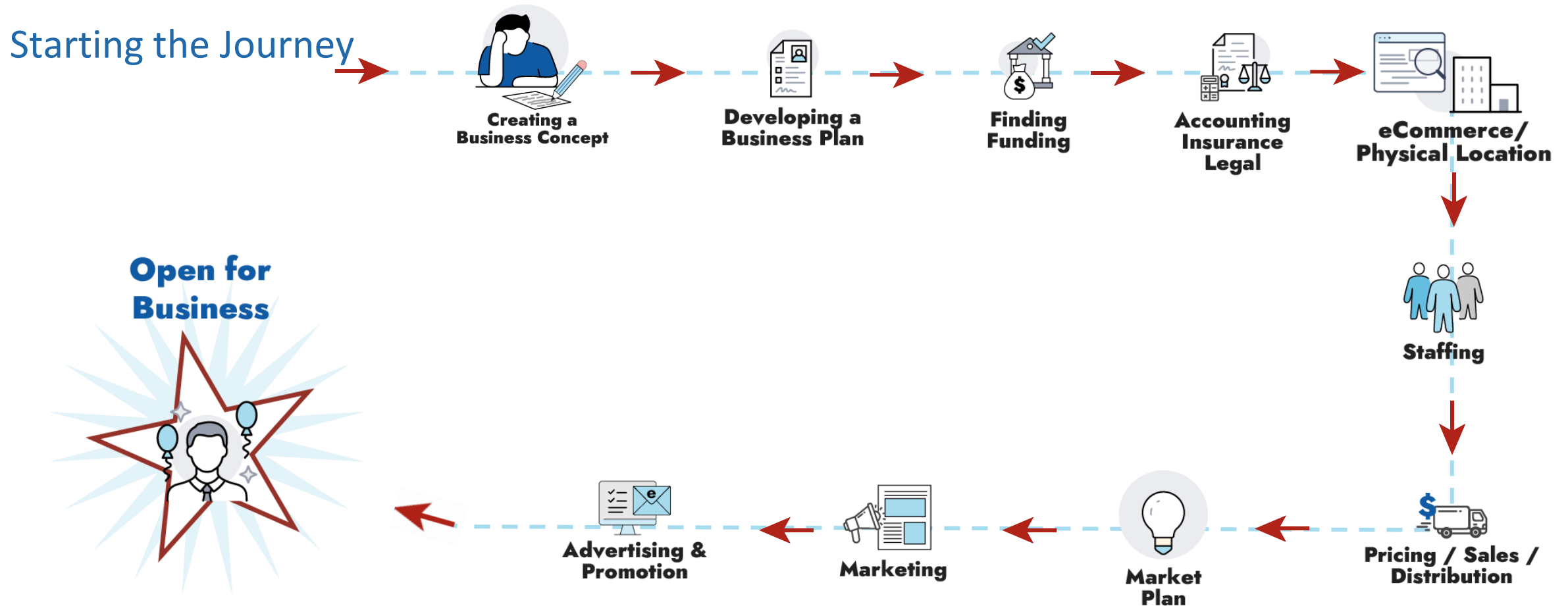
- Veterans
- Veteran Leadership
- SBA Leadership
- SCORE Leadership
- SCORE Mentors

SCORE Assists Entrepreneurs in All Stages of Small Business Life Cycle

Starting a Business → Growing a Business → Selling a Business

- Building a New Business
- Buying Existing Business
- Buying a Franchise

Veterans Small Businesses – Roadmap for Success



*Note –these activities can be reordered to meet specific business needs

| Building a Business

Creating a Business Concept

Are You the Next Veteran Entrepreneur? Vet-to-Vet Advice About Business Ownership

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •



Duration: 1.5 Hours

Language: English

[VIEW WEBINAR](#)

Viewing this webinar requires some basic information. This data is only used within SCORE and will not be distributed to any third parties.

SCORE Webinar: [Are You the Next Veteran Entrepreneur? Vet-to-Vet Advice About Business Ownership](#)

Creating a Business Concept (cont'd)

Simple Steps for Starting Your Business – Business Concept

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •



Duration: 60 minutes

Language: English

[VIEW WEBINAR](#)

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SCORE Webinar: [Simple Steps for Starting Your Business – Business Concept](#)

Developing a One-page Business Plan

IDENTITY

- Describe your business in one sentence. What do you do, who do you do it for, what sets you apart from the competition and what defines you as a business

PROBLEM WORTH SOLVING

- Describe problems that your potential customers have and why they need your products or services?

OUR SOLUTION

- Describe your product or service and how it solves your customer's problem

TARGET MARKET

- Who are your customers? Describe your ideal customer and how many there are

THE COMPETITION

- What other products and services do your potential customers use today to solve their problems? How are you better than the competition?

SALES CHANNELS

- Describe how you will sell to your customers e.g. storefront, website, sales team, distributors

Developing a One-page Business Plan

MARKETING ACTIVITIES

- Primary ways you will reach your customers.
Describe planned activities such as advertising, PR

REVENUE

- Primary revenue streams, how you will make money, what products or services will generate revenue

EXPENSES

- List your major expenses - areas that you expect to spend the most money on to successfully launch

MILESTONES

- Primary goals and objectives to take your business from idea to reality over the next few months

TEAM AND KEY ROLES

- List names and positions of business partners and/or key new hires to help you launch the business

PARTNERS AND RESOURCES

- Key partners, resources, or intellectual property needed to successfully launch

Developing a Business Plan

Business Plan Templates

You can use the templates below as a starting point to create your startup business plan or map out how you will expand your existing business. Then meet with a [SCORE mentor](#) to get expert business planning advice and feedback on your business plan.



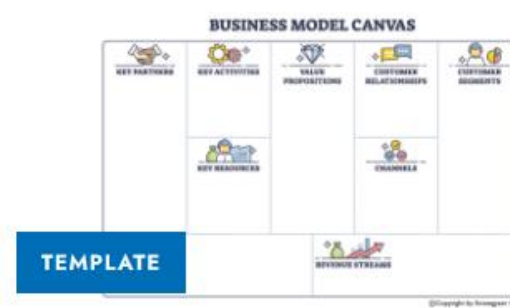
Business Plan Template for a Startup Business

To increase your odds of a successful business startup, download this step-by-step business plan template you can use to...



Business Plan Template for an Established Business

Download our free business plan template for your established business as a Word doc. A business plan for an established business...



Template: Business Model Canvas

If writing a full business plan seems overwhelming, start with a one-page Business Model Canvas. Developed by...

SCORE Webinar: [Business Planning & Financial Statements Template Gallery](#)

| Buying a Business

Buying a Business

Buying a Business

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •

★★★★★



Duration: 90 minutes

Language: English

[VIEW WEBINAR](#)

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[Buying a Business | SCORE](#)

| Buying a Franchise

Should You Buy a Franchise or Start Your Own Business?

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •



Duration: 1 Hour

Language: English

[VIEW WEBINAR](#)

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[Event Registration | SCORE](#)

Buying a Franchise

Is Buying a Franchise Right for you?

June 13, 2024



[Is Buying a Franchise Right for you? | SCORE](#)

| Finding Funding

Finding Funding

The Startup Roadmap: Finding Funding

ONLINE COURSE •
★★★★★



TAKE THE COURSE

***Note:**

SCORE assists in accessing
potential sources of funding

**SCORE does not provide grants
or loans**

SCORE Webinar: [The Startup Roadmap: Finding Funding](#)

Finding Funding - SCORE is a Resource Partner with SBA

Need a Business Loan to Start, Grow, or Expand?



The SBA works with approved lenders to offer **microloans** and **SBA-backed loans** with:

- Competitive terms
- Lower down payments
- Flexible overhead requirements
- Counseling and education



6

Finding Funding – SBA Funding Programs



Loans

Start or expand your business with loans guaranteed by the Small Business Administration.



Investment capital

Find an investor for your business. Investors make both debt and equity investments.



Disaster assistance

Get help after a disaster with low-interest disaster loans from the Small Business Administration.



Surety bonds

Protect your work and your client with an SBA-guaranteed surety bond.

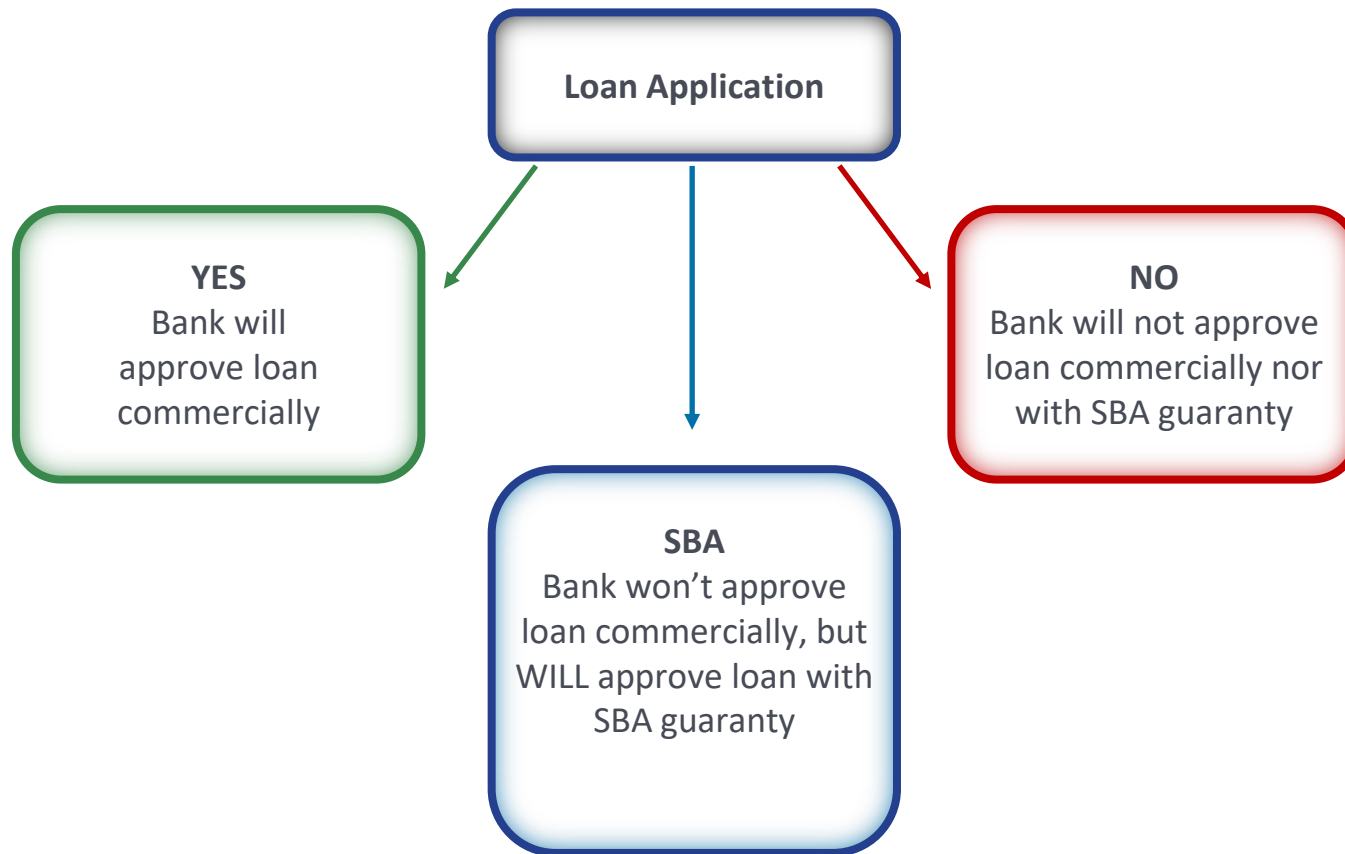


Grants

Look for government grants that help businesses do scientific research and development.

Finding Funding –Bank Loans & SBA 7A Guarantees

When Does the Bank Use SBA?



Finding Funding – SBA Lender Match Services

Lender Match

Lender Match connects you to lenders by getting matched to potential lenders offering SBA-backed funding:

- Using Lender Match doesn't guarantee that you'll get matched or be offered a loan.
- Ask lenders about interest rates, minimum credit score, cash flow requirements, and other qualifying factors.
- Lender Match submits loan requests to participating Community Development Financial Institutions and small asset lenders.
- Find an SBA-approved lender at SBA.gov/lendermatch

1.
Describe
Your Needs



2.
Interested Lenders
Reply Within 2 Days



3.
Talk to
Lenders



4.
Apply for a
Loan



Finding Funding – Programs for Women-owned Small Businesses

Best Small Business Financing Options for Women in 2023



by Rieva Lesonsky • March 2, 2023 •



SCORE Article: [Best Small Business Financing Options for Women in 2023](#)

Finding Funding – Programs for Black-owned Small Businesses

12 Funding Options for Black-Owned Businesses



by Brett Farmiloe

February 19, 2024



SCORE Article: [12 Funding Options for Black-Owned Businesses](#)

Finding Funding – Programs for Hispanic-owned Small Businesses

11 Funding Resources for Hispanic and Latino Small Business Owners

 by Maria Valdez Haubrich • January 24, 2024 •
★★★★★



Syracuse University Publication

[Hispanics and Latinos in the Military: The Path from Service to Veteran Entrepreneurship](#)

SCORE Article: [11 Funding Resources for Hispanic and Latino Small Business Owners](#)

Finding Funding - Competitions

Fund Your Veteran-Owned Business through Competitions



by Lee Mills

• February 11, 2024 •



SCORE Article: [Fund Your Veteran-Owned Business through Competitions](#)

| Accounting, Insurance, Legal

The Startup Roadmap: Accounting, Insurance, and Legal Considerations

ONLINE COURSE •
★★★★★



TAKE THE COURSE

SCORE Course: [The Startup Roadmap: Accounting, Insurance, and Legal Considerations](#)



Business Location

Business Location – Physical Location

The Startup Roadmap: Setting Up Your Physical Location

ONLINE COURSE •
★★★★★



TAKE THE COURSE

SCORE Course: [The Startup Roadmap: Setting Up Your Physical Location](#)

Business Location – eCommerce Presence

Starting an Online Business? Here's What You Need to Know



by Teri Ambrose • March 8, 2023 •



SCORE Resource: [Starting an Online Business? Here's What You Need to Know](#)

Business Location – eCommerce Presence

Building a Foundation for Online Marketing Success: Review, Plan, and Execute

A 2024 National Small Business Week Virtual Summit Webinar

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •
★★★★★



Duration: 1 Hour

Language: English

[VIEW WEBINAR](#)

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SCORE Webinar: [Building a Foundation for Online Marketing Success: Review, Plan, and Execute](#)

| Staffing

The Startup Roadmap: Staffing Your Business

ONLINE COURSE •
★★★★★



TAKE THE COURSE

SCORE Course: [The Startup Roadmap: Staffing Your Business](#)

| Pricing, Sales, Distribution

The Startup Roadmap: Pricing, Sales, and Distribution

ONLINE COURSE •
★★★★★



TAKE THE COURSE

SCORE Course: [The Startup Roadmap: Pricing, Sales, and Distribution](#)

| Marketing, Advertising, Promotion

The Startup Roadmap: Marketing Your Business

ONLINE COURSE •



TAKE THE COURSE

SCORE Course: [The Startup Roadmap: Marketing Your Business](#)

Marketing Tips for Your Veteran-Owned Business



by Lee Mills • November 9, 2023 •



SCORE Article: [Marketing Tips for Your Veteran-Owned Business](#)

Marketing (cont'd)

Win Customers: Turn Military Speak into Civilian Speak



by Matt Louis

• October 31, 2023 •



SCORE Article: [Win Customers: Turn Military Speak into Civilian Speak](#)

Learn How to Sell While Spending Less on Advertising and Promotions

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •



Duration: 90 minutes

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[VIEW WEBINAR](#)

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SCORE Webinar: [Learn How to Sell While Spending Less on Advertising and Promotions](#)

Open For Business

The Startup Roadmap: Open for Business

ONLINE COURSE •
★★★★☆



TAKE THE COURSE

Open for Business



SCORE Course: [The Startup Roadmap: Open for Business](#)



Growing a Business

Advertising & Promotion

Growth Strategies for Veteran Entrepreneurs

October 31, 2023 •



SCORE Article: [Growth Strategies for Veteran Entrepreneurs](#)

SBA Program for Service-Disabled Veterans



Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business program

Program benefits

The federal government aims to award at least 5% of all federal contracting dollars to SDVOSBs each year.

Competition is limited for certain federal contract opportunities to businesses that participate in the SDVOSB program.

Joining the SDVOSB program makes your business eligible to compete for the program's [set-aside and sole source contracts](#).

SBA Resource: [Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business program](#)

Clients of our APEX Accelerator Assistance Center get:



ONE-ON-ONE COUNSELING

Get no-cost access to a trusted gov. marketing advisor. Ofrecemos consultas en Español también.



INVITED TO WORKSHOPS & EVENTS

Attend instructor-led workshops delivered in-person and virtually.



ACCESS TO BIDMATCH

Get the latest bid opportunities straight to your inbox.



AND MORE!

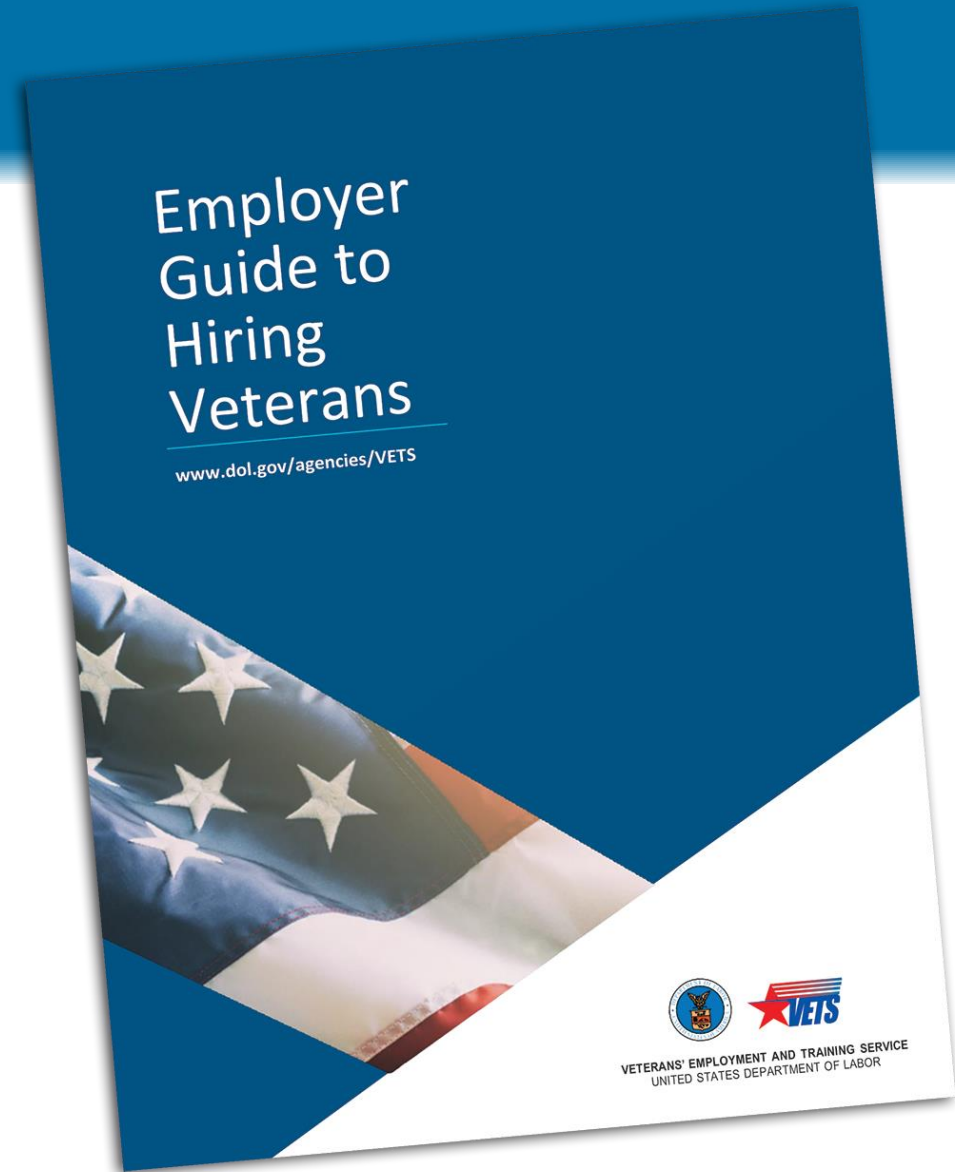
Visit our Services page to see how we can help you!

Hiring Veterans



VETERANS' EMPLOYMENT AND TRAINING SERVICE
UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

SCORE Webinar: [Employer Guide to Hiring Veterans](https://www.dol.gov/agencies/VETS)



| Selling a Business

How to Sell your Business

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •



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<https://www.score.org/palmbeachcounty/event/how-sell-your-business-1>

<https://www.score.org/longisland/resource/eguide/exiting-or-selling-a-business>

Selling A Business Webinar



- **Len Briskman** has a 50-year career where he has held positions as Director of International Finance for two Fortune 100 companies, and founder and CEO of a 42 store retail chain, which was listed as one of the top 100 public companies in the DC area. As a government program manager, he was responsible for the evaluation, monitoring, and disposal of all operating businesses, real estate, and complex financial instruments seized and forfeited by the US Department of Justice for criminal activities. As a SCORE volunteer, and team leader of the Business Advisory Services, he assists clients in evaluating businesses for purchase, sale, financing, and restructuring.

- [PowerPoint Presentation](#)

SCORE Assists Veterans in All Stages of Small Business Life Cycle

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